



EMPOWER Labs

Session 9: Execution Systems

Today, we'll cover the second "E" in EMPOWER – **Execution Systems**.

We transition from planning to execution, where we'll build the operational backbone of your business through systematic implementation.

Program Timeline



Milestones: Where You Should Be at This Point

-  — Ran the Workforce & Leadership Diagnostic
-  — Created Level 1 & 2 SOP (Hire to Retire) (Optional)
-  — Added and Ran the AI Hiring Protocol (Optional)

 **Poll:** Have you completed the exercises up until this session? (excl. optional exercises)

What You'll Get Out of This Session



1. Execution
Systems

2. Preparing to
Execute with AI

3. Implementat-
ion Best
Practices



Part 1: Execution Systems

What Are Execution Systems?



Operational Backbone

Systems and processes that ensure consistent delivery of your products and services.



Quality Management

Tools that embed quality assurance at every step of your operations.



Feedback Loops

Continuous improvement through internal audits and measurement systems.



Common Execution System Components



Prioritization

OKR planning rhythms and focus

Metrics

KPIs, scoreboards, dashboards

Communication

Regular rhythms and stakeholder updates

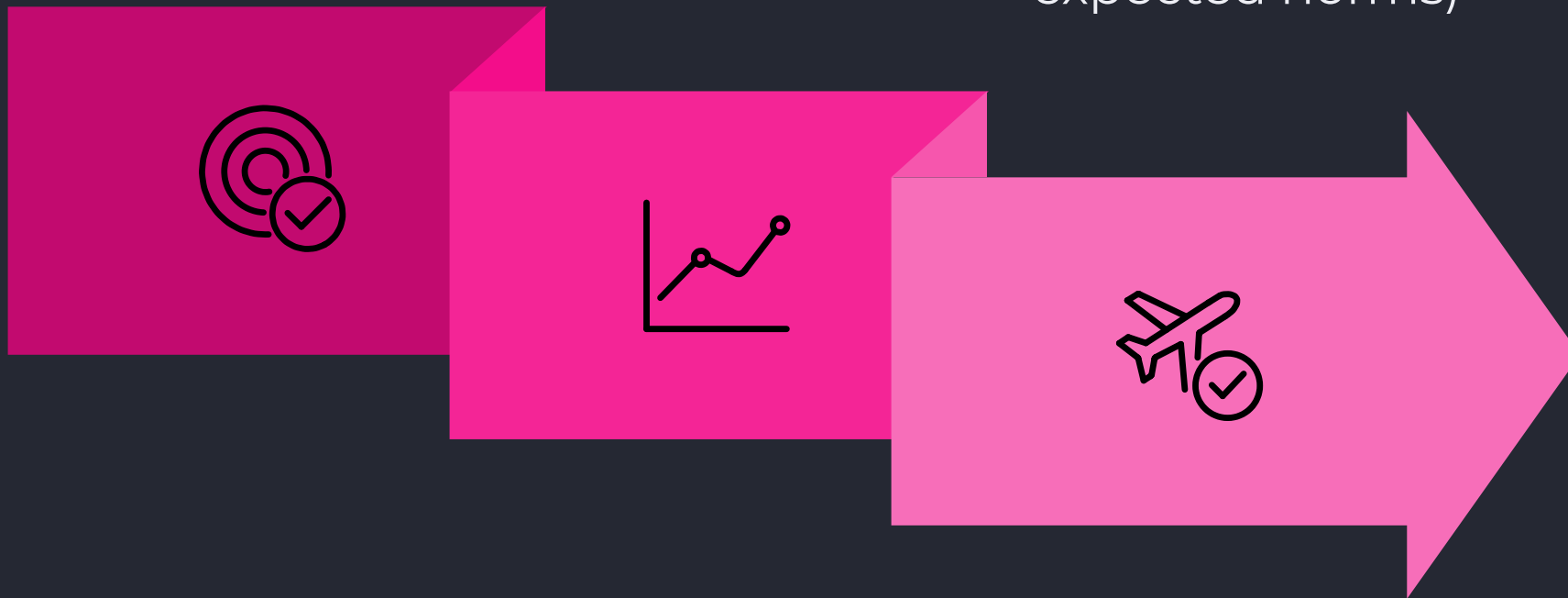
Attributes of a Great Priority / Rock / OKR

S.M.A.R.T

(Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-Bound) and move a key metric

Momentum

Move the company forward (vs. maintain expected norms)

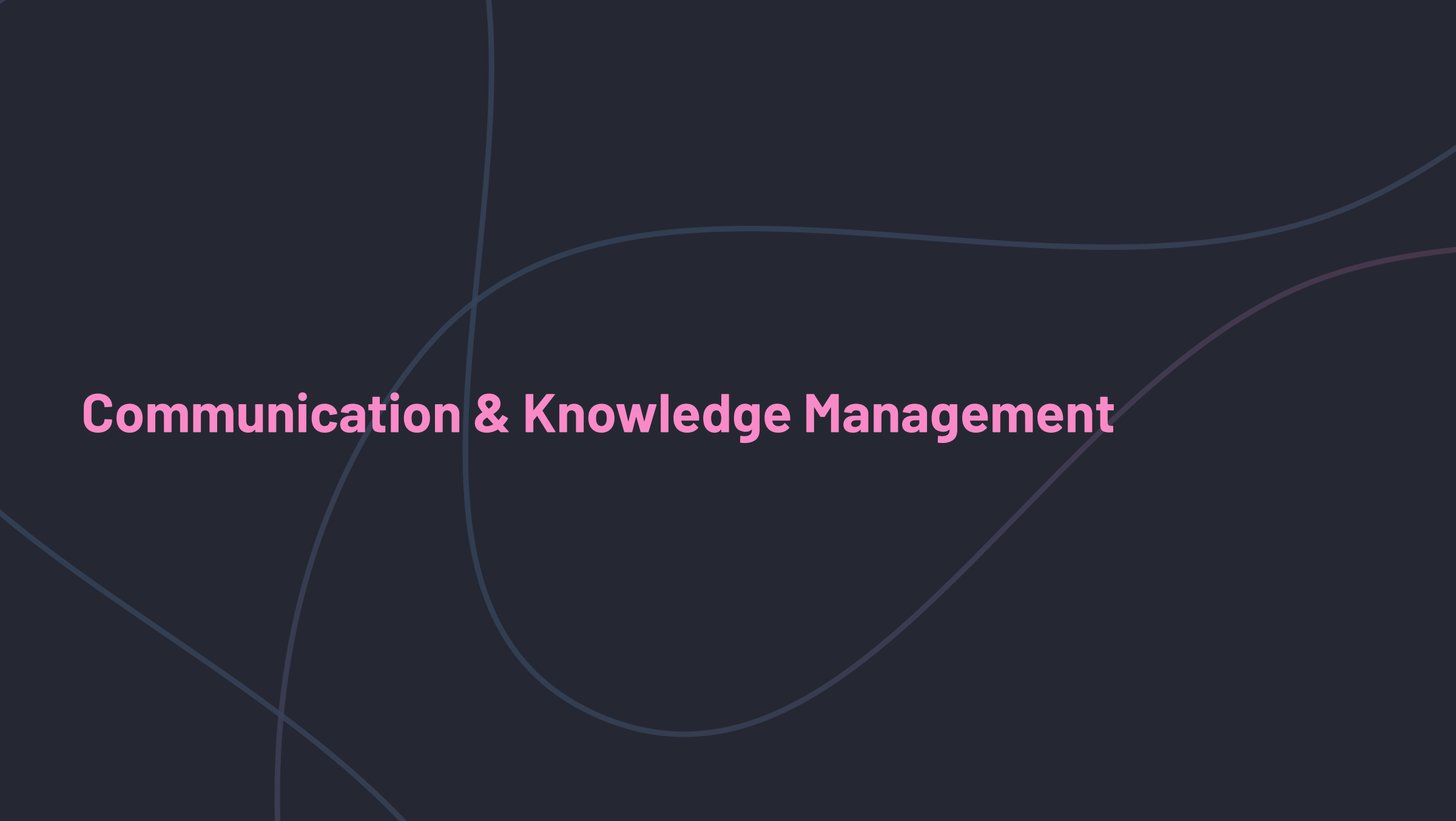


Milestones

Can be broken down into meaningful steps

Elements of a Great Company Scoreboard

- **Contain a mix of evergreen, functional, and critical numbers**
- **Tied to Core Processes and Roles**
- **Represent a balance of leading (activities) and lagging (results) indicators**
- **Include appropriate financial and non-financial KPIs**



Communication & Knowledge Management

Common Communication Problems



No systematic communication cadence

Information silos develop when companies lack structured communication rhythms, leading to misalignment and duplicated efforts.



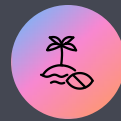
Knowledge transfer gaps

Critical information often resides only with specific individuals, creating single points of failure when people leave or are unavailable.



Meeting inefficiency

Time is wasted in poorly structured meetings that lack clear agendas, facilitation, and documented outcomes.



Remote work challenges

Distributed teams face additional barriers to maintaining culture, alignment, and effective communication without intentional systems.

Communication Cadence Structure



Meeting Rules: MUST start on time - people come early. Every meeting has clear outcomes and next steps. Use AI to optimize preparation and follow-up.

Poll: Which of These Communication Cadences Are You Observing Already?

A) Daily Standups

B) 1-on-1s

C) Weekly Leadership Meetings

D) Monthly Business Review

E) Quarterly / Annual Planning Meeting

F) Town Halls / All Hands

Town Halls / All Hands Structure



Vision Communication

Leadership shares clear direction and future plans.



Leadership-Led

Executive team runs these meetings directly.



Customer Success Stories

Showcase real transformations and outcomes.

New Team Integration

Formally welcome recent hires with brief introductions.

Values Recognition

Celebrate specific employees demonstrating core values.

Quarterly Theme

Announce and reinforce the company's focus area for next 90 days.

Level 10 Leadership Meeting Structure (60 Minutes)

Meeting Flow - First Half:



Level 10 Leadership Meeting Structure (60 Minutes)

Meeting Flow - Second Half:

IDS - Identify, Discuss, Solve (45 min)
Focus on most important issues facing the business.

6

7

Conclude (5 min)

Recap to-dos, rate meeting, provide feedback.

Meeting Rules: MUST start on time - people come early; AI rates the meeting according to agreed rubric; Every issue gets next step + owner.

AI-Enhanced Communication Systems



Meeting Preparation

AI automatically generates meeting agendas and provides relevant background information to participants.



Knowledge Capture

AI systems document tribal knowledge before people leave and create searchable knowledge bases from conversations.



Communication Optimization

AI tools improve message tone, timing, and effectiveness by suggesting improvements for clarity and impact.



Follow-up Automation

AI automatically extracts action items from meetings, assigns them to owners, and tracks completion.



Part 2: Preparing to Execute With AI

Why Most Implementations Fail

1 No Clear Ownership

When nobody owns a process, it becomes everybody's afterthought and nobody's priority.

2 Poorly Defined Success Metrics

Without clear targets, teams celebrate meaningless milestones while missing true objectives.

3 Feedback Loops Too Slow

Problems compound when detection takes weeks instead of days or hours.

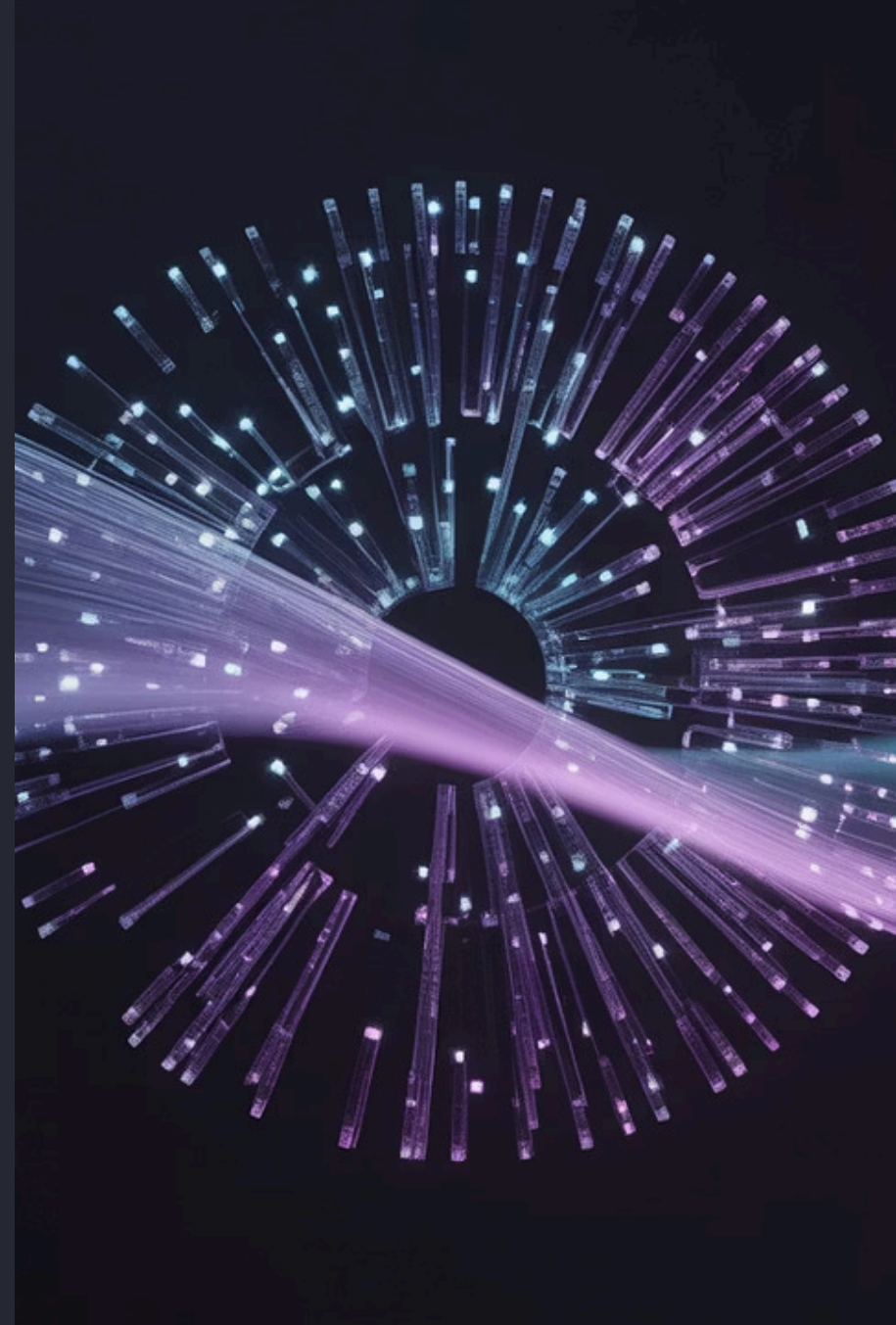
 Implementation without accountability is wishful thinking.



The Implementation Mindset

Process improvement is never finished

- Start with an 80% solution
- Iterate based on real usage
- Ask users what's not working
- Fix bottlenecks immediately



Implementation Roles: The AI Visionary

CEO/Founder drives the change

- Hosts Town Hall meeting announcing importance
- Clearly states "This is our new standard"
- Sets expectation from the top
- Creates urgency and priority

Without visionary commitment, teams ignore change.



Implementation Roles: The AI Operator

COO/Manager drives adoption

Works in the operational details daily, turning vision into reality.

- Sets up incentives for process owners
- Tracks adoption rates religiously
- Removes obstacles to compliance

The bridge between vision and execution.



Implementation Roles: The AI Implementer

Technical person who executes the work

May be integrator, developer, or process owner depending on complexity.

- Sets up automation and tracking systems
- Builds forms, templates, and dashboards
- Configures alerts and reporting tools

Makes the magic happen behind the scenes.



Selecting Your AI Operator

Critical role for implementation success

- Technically capable with AI tools
- Detail-oriented and process-minded
- Curious and obsessive (doesn't stop until it's done)
- Has time and authority to drive change
- Comfortable with iteration and feedback

Wrong person = failed implementation.

Building AI Operator Buy-In

Show them the vision

- How AI will make their job easier
- Specific time savings they'll gain
- Career development opportunity
- Authority and ownership they'll have

Make them excited, not threatened.

AI Operator Master Prompt Development

Basic Understanding

Start with simple master prompts to build confidence.

AI Capability Exploration

Let them experience progressive improvement through iteration.

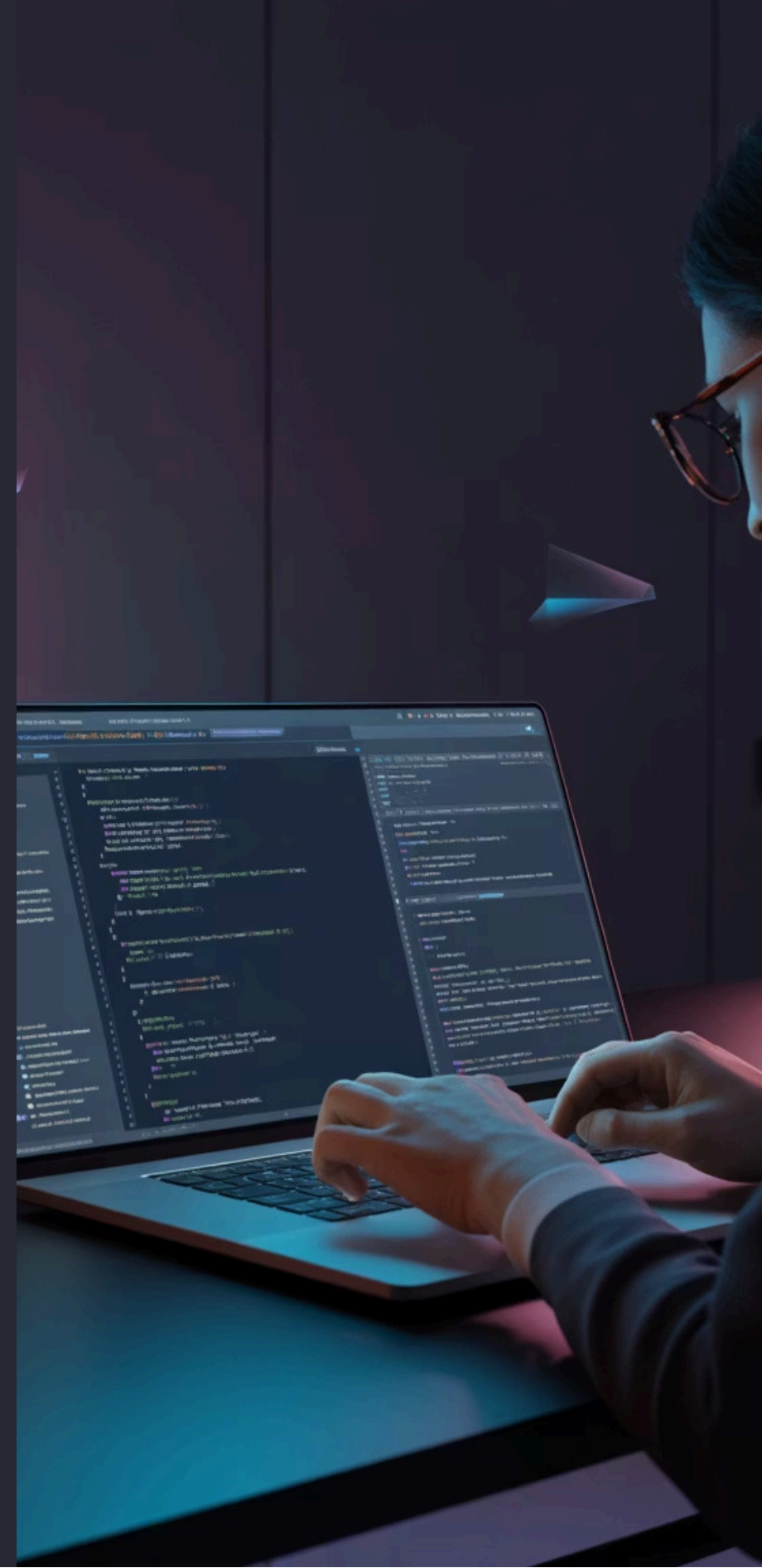
Business Context Integration

Introduce your full business context to improve relevance.

Personalization

Help them customize for their communication style and needs.

 Understanding beats copying every time.



Poll: Who Will Be Your AI Operator?

A) Me (the owner)

I'll learn the AI skills myself

B) My operations/right-hand person

They handle day-to-day processes

C) Current process owner

Person who already does this work daily

D) Most tech-savvy team member

Best with software and learning new tools

E) Administrative/office manager

Handles our systems and procedures

F) Need to hire/train someone

Don't have right skills in-house yet

G) Not sure yet

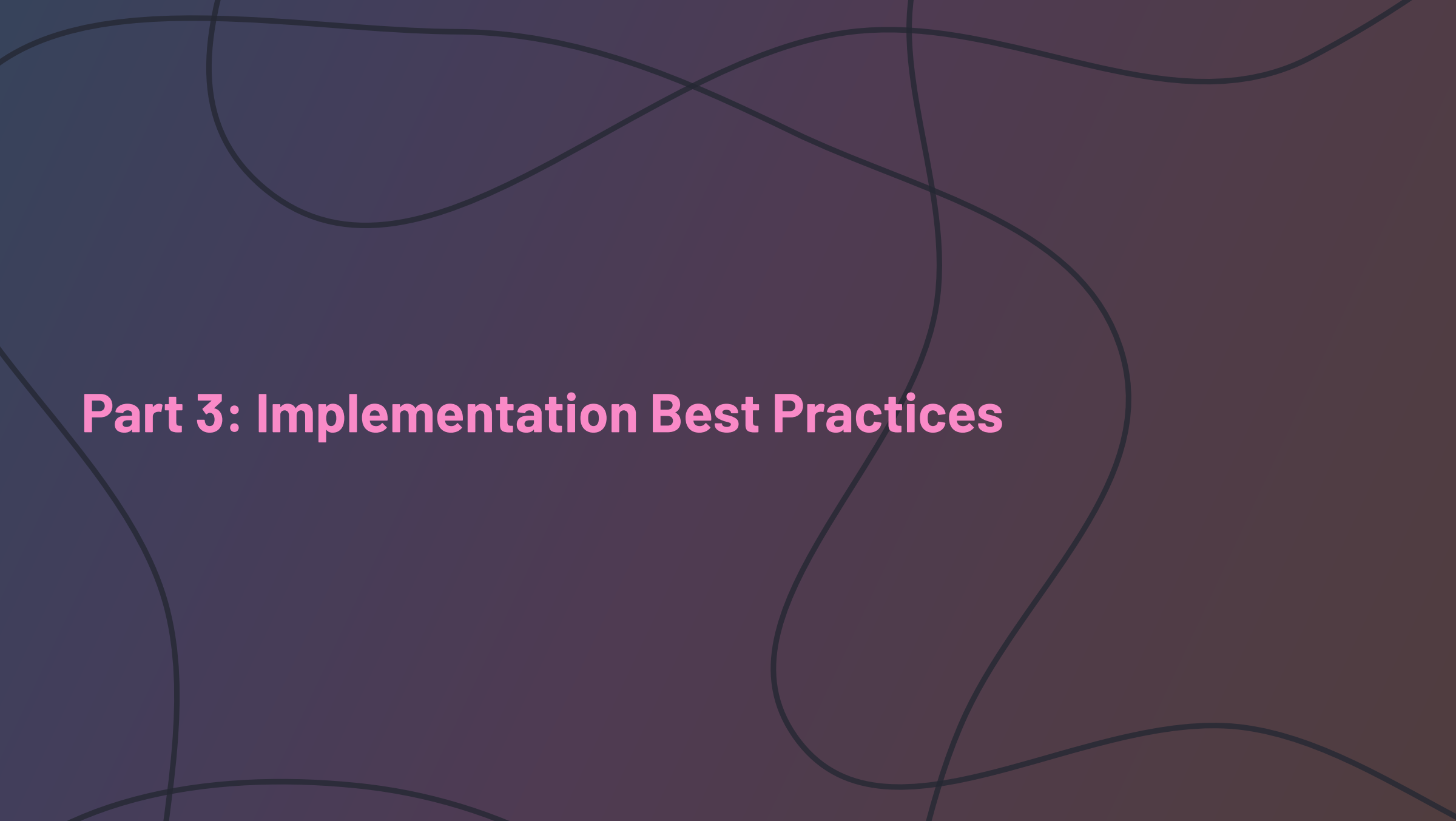
Still evaluating options

Breakout Discussion

Take 10 minutes in groups of 3-4 to introduce yourselves and answer:

Talk about your answer to the poll. Why did you pick that person?





Part 3: Implementation Best Practices

The 3 Stages of Process Implementation

Stage 1: Awareness

- Process exists and is documented
- Everyone knows where to find it
- Clear documentation is accessible

i "I didn't know I had to do it" becomes impossible.



The 3 Stages of Process Implementation

Stage 2: Manual Tracking

- Process has clear owner
- KPIs manually recorded and discussed
- Green, yellow, red system in meetings
- Weekly accountability cadence

① Meetings drive accountability.



The Three Stages of Process Implementation

Stage 3: Automated Tracking

- Process owner monitors automated KPIs
- Dashboards display real-time metrics
- Bot notifications alert to issues
- Daily feedback enables rapid correction

 Bots drive accountability better than humans.



Poll: What Stage of Process Implementation Are You At?

A) Stage 0

No process or awareness

B) Stage 1

Awareness

C) Stage 2

Manual tracking

D) Stage 3

Automated tracking

How to Choose What to Implement First

1 Highest Business Impact

Revenue increase, cost reduction, stress reduction, or risk mitigation.

2 Highest AI Leverage

Where AI can create 10x improvement in efficiency or effectiveness.

3 Lowest Implementation Complexity

Choose simpler processes first to build momentum and confidence.

4 Clear Ownership Available

Someone must be ready and willing to take responsibility.

5 Measurable Within 5 Days

Fast feedback loops enable rapid improvement and course correction.

Defining "Highest Business Impact"

Increased Revenue

More sales or higher prices per transaction.



Decreased Costs

Less waste, fewer errors, and improved efficiency.



Mitigated Risks

Greater safety for company, customers, and stakeholders.



Reduced Stress

Quality of life improvements for you and your team.



Rank your processes by which delivers most value in these areas.

AI Leverage Assessment

Look for 10x improvement opportunities:

- Processes with lots of manual work
- Repetitive decision-making tasks
- Data analysis and reporting
- Customer communication flows
- Quality checking and reviews
- Documentation and record-keeping

 Avoid processes with diminishing AI returns.

Your Implementation Decision Framework

Impact

High/Medium/Low

Readiness

Ready/Not Ready

Complexity

High/Medium/Low

Resources

Available/Not Available

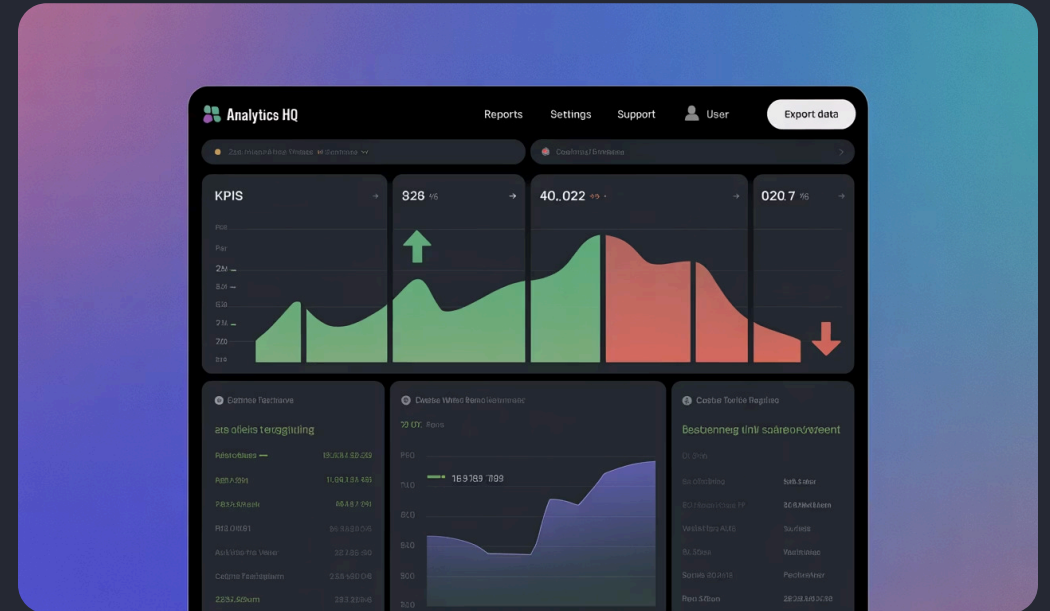
 Start with High Impact, Low Complexity, Ready, Available.

Review Your Core Process First

Success must be correctly defined

- Impactful metrics, not vanity metrics
- Controllable by the process owner
- Leading indicators tied to outcomes
- Feedback loop under 5 days maximum

 Garbage metrics = garbage results.



Core Process Success Criteria

Clear Definition

Is success specifically and measurably defined?

Owner Control

Can the owner directly influence this metric?

Incentive Alignment

Does it align with their personal incentives?

Quick Measurement

Can we measure it within 5 days?

i **Fix these before building anything else.** Each core process has a success metric, a target, and an understanding of who tracks it, how and how often.

Blueprint Review: Creating Workflows

Workflows are process instances in action

- Blueprint = template, Workflow = execution
- Each workflow has trackable checklist
- Every step has due date and owner
- Triggers start steps, outputs trigger next steps
- Each blueprint has a success metric, a target, and an understanding of who tracks it, how and how often

Success Criteria Questions:

- Is success clearly defined?
- Can the owner control this metric?
- Can we measure it within 5 days?

 Turn static processes into dynamic workflows.

Guide Review: Four Implementation Scenarios

Scenario 1

No guide, process not happening. Use generated guide as starting point.

Scenario 2

No guide, process happening. Compare reality to generated guide.

Scenario 3

Have guide, process not happening. Show SOP to owner, get feedback.

Scenario 4

Have guide, process happening. Compare current SOP to generated one.

i **Truth lives in the execution, not the document.** Each Guide has a success metric, a target, and an understanding of who tracks it, how and how often

Questions & Discussion Break

Quick pulse check before we dive into execution

What questions do you have about:

- Selecting your AI Operator?
- Reviewing your current processes?
- Preparing for implementation?

We're about to cover the execution framework - let's make sure you're ready.

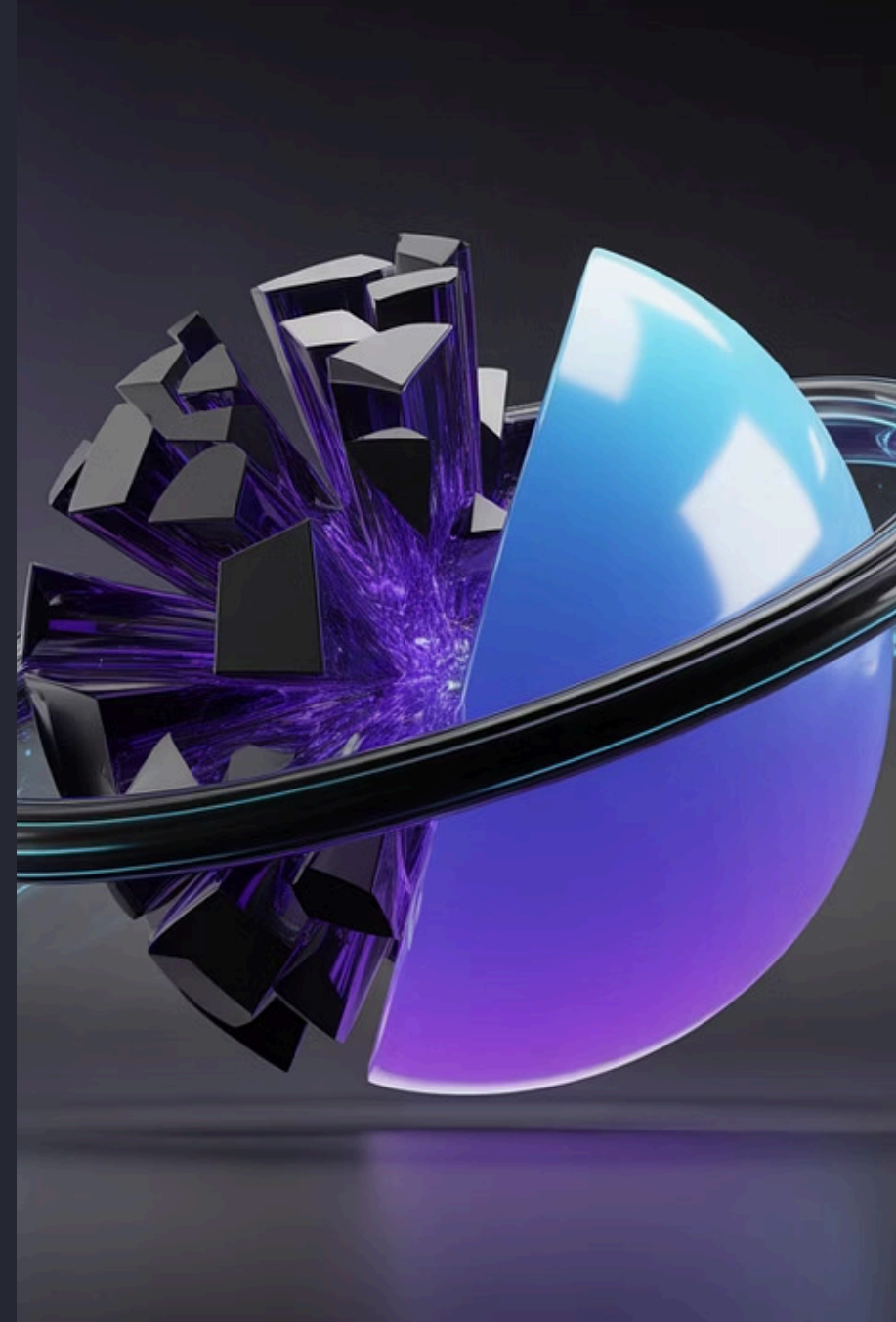


AI Integration Opportunities

Ask your LLM:

"What new possibilities does AI create for this specific process that were previously impossible?"

Focus on your business's weakest areas for maximum impact.

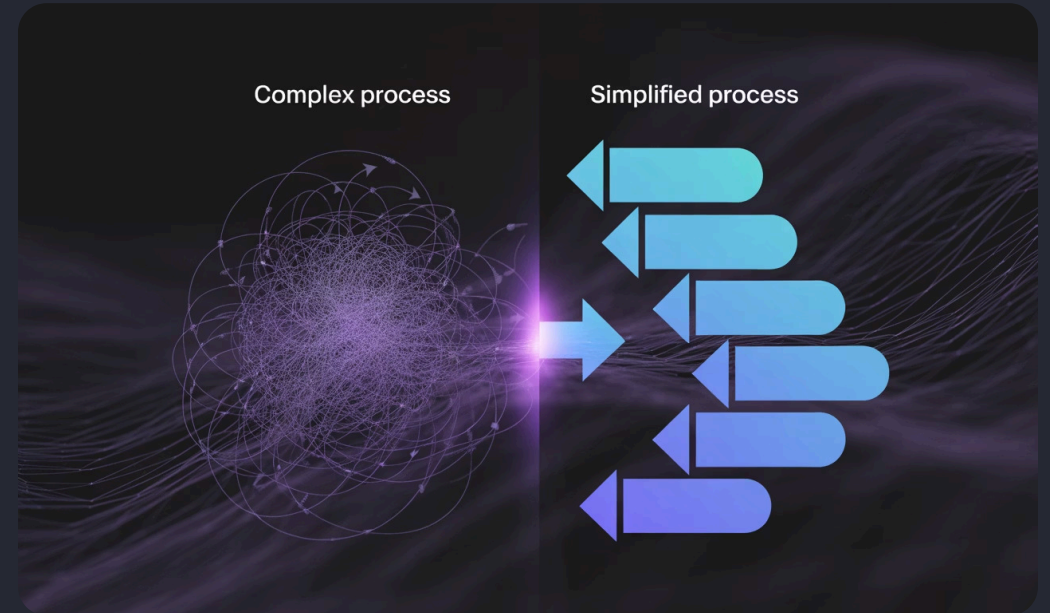


The Minimum Viable Process

Start with bare essentials:

- What absolutely must happen?
- Who must do it?
- When must it be done?
- How do we know it worked?
- How is success tracked as a metric?
- Who tracks it, how, and how often?

i Add complexity only when justified by results.



Implementation Pitfalls to Avoid

❌ Don't assume AI got it right

Always validate AI-generated processes through real-world testing.

❌ Don't over-engineer everything

Complex processes are harder to follow and maintain consistently.

❌ Don't skip ownership assignment

Processes without clear owners become organizational orphans.

① Validate through execution. Start simple, iterate quickly.



Poll: What's Your Biggest Implementation Concern?

A) Finding Operator

Don't have someone technical enough

B) Team Resistance

People won't follow the new process

C) Time Investment

Too busy to do implementation properly

D) Getting It Wrong

Process won't work or need major changes

E) Measuring Success

Don't know how to track if it's working

F) Scaling Beyond First Process

Making this repeatable



Other Best Practices

✓ Always validate through execution

Real-world testing reveals issues no planning session can predict.

✓ Start simple, add complexity when justified

Begin with an MVP and expand based on proven value and need.

✓ Focus on highest-impact processes first

Prioritize where business outcomes will be most significantly improved.

❗ Perfect is the enemy of done.



Building Implementation Momentum

Choose Process with Clear ROI

Start with something that will show obvious, measurable improvement.

Celebrate Early Successes

Publicly recognize achievements to build enthusiasm and buy-in.

Share Specific Metrics

Communicate exact improvements in time, quality, or cost savings.

Collect User Testimonials

Let team members share how the process improved their work life.

 Success stories create momentum for further implementation.

The Implementation Multiplier Effect

One good process creates others

- Teams see the value more clearly
- Resistance naturally decreases
- Implementation skills improve
- Culture shifts toward improvement

 First process is the hardest. Each subsequent one gets easier.

The Implementation Commitment

Leadership Commitment

You must visibly prioritize and champion the implementation.



Measurement Discipline

Regular tracking and reporting must become routine.



Team Execution

Process owners must take ownership of their responsibilities.



Organizational Support

Resources and time must be allocated for success.



i Half-hearted implementation = whole-hearted failure.

Creating Your Initial Implementation Plan

Prompt Walkthrough

- **Phase 1: Choose highest-priority implementation**

Apply the criteria we discussed to select your focus process (impact, AI leverage potential, implementation complexity, current pain level, resource availability, measurability)

- **Phase 2: Select and train your AI Operator**

Ensure they have necessary prerequisites and buy-in.

- **Phase 3: Complete tech stack assessment and create 2-week sprint plan**

Document your current tools and integration opportunities. Claude will create a detailed implementation plan, incl. ownership, timeline and measurement approach.

- **Phase 4: Kick-off preparation**

Receive a master prompt amendment and an implementation kick-off checklist from Claude.

Q&A

Your turn to ask your questions!



Your Next Steps

01

Prepare for Implementation

Collect materials from previous session to get ready for implementation.

02

Create Your Initial Implementation Plan

Let's plan and prepare for the first process implementation in your business.

Optional Exercises

01

Design a Process Quality Management System

Think systematically about process governance before expanding your SOP library.

02

Run Advanced Process Optimization

Customize AI-generated processes specifically for your business reality, team capabilities, and competitive situation.

03

Create Your Advanced Implementation Plan

Plan how to systematically roll out process improvements across your entire business, creating maximum impact with minimum chaos.

04

Design an AI-Enhanced Business Intelligence System

Design an AI-powered system to turn data into competitive intelligence and business optimization insights.

Office Hours

Wednesday March 4th at 10 am PT / 1 pm ET

Live Session 10: Robust Market Position

Friday, March 6th at 10 am PT / 1 pm ET

